

Life on us

Warm and moist, your skin makes a perfect home for millions of germs and bugs that are often too small to see with the naked eye. Unknowingly, we carry around these passengers day and night. Many feed on skin cells and oils; others suck blood. Luckily for us, these passengers are often harmless, and some even protect us from dangerous germs.

Head lice have gray-brown bodies, but after feeding on blood they can often look reddish. Hungry head lice can feed up to five times a day.

The needle-like sucking mouthparts withdraw when a louse is not feeding.

◀ **HEAD LOUSE**
In microscopic view, this head louse can be seen gripping on to a strand of hair.

